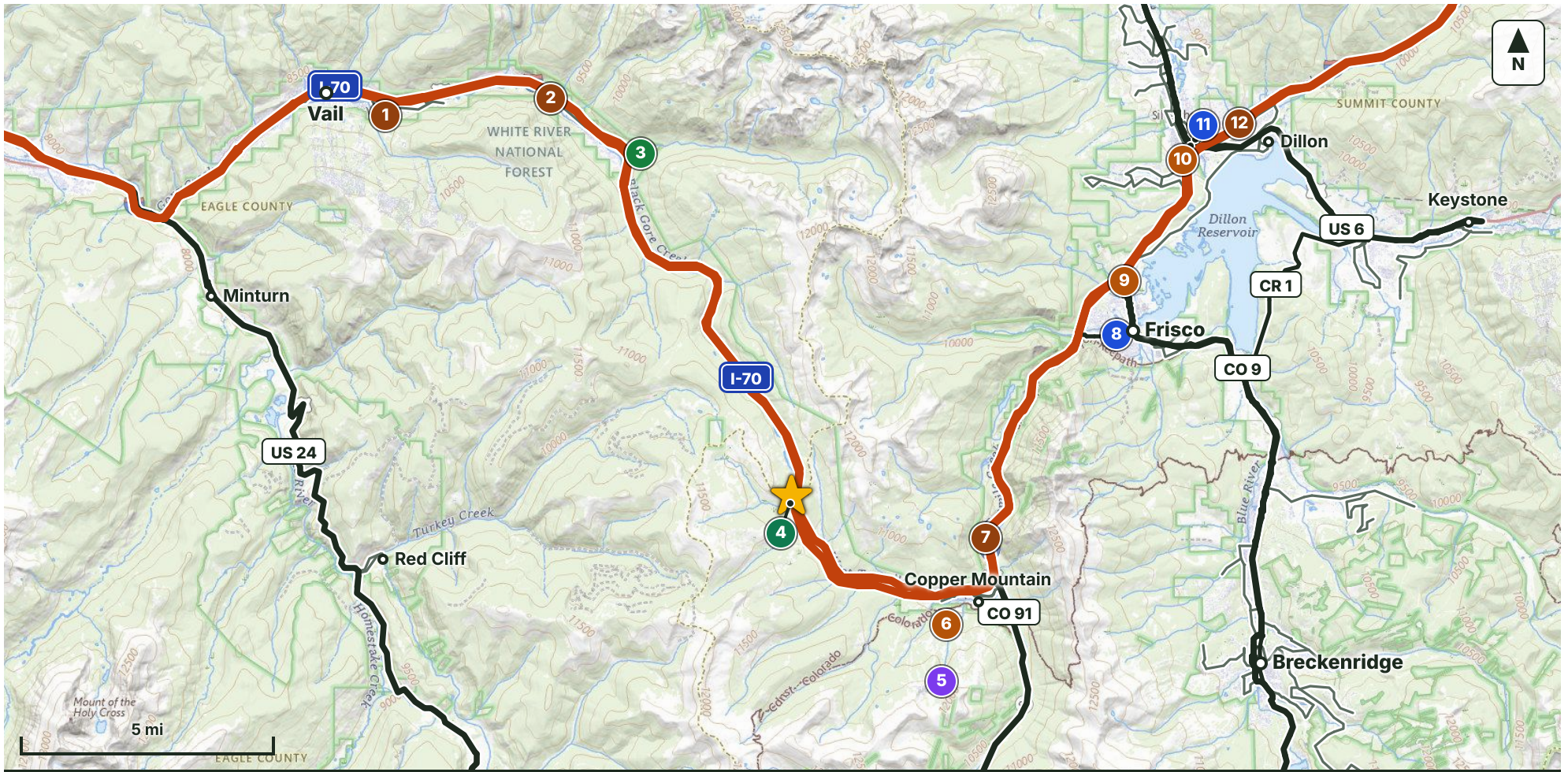




I-70 • COLORADO

Vail Pass

10,662 ft
summit elevation

~100 mi
west of Denver on
I-70

- 1** Vail Trail
- 2** Gore Valley Trail
- 3** Gore Creek Campground
- 4** CDOT Rest Area: Vail Pass
- 5** Copper Mountain Ski area
- 6** Fuel
- 7** Gore Range Trailhead
- 8** Old Town Hall Visitor center
- 9** Circle K Fuel
- 10** 7-Eleven Fuel
- 11** Silverthorne Welcome Center Visitor center
- 12** Ptarmigan Peak Trailhead

- ★ Vail Pass
- Freeway
- Highway
- Local road
- Visitor center
- Rest area
- Fuel
- Ski area
- Campground
- Trailhead

Base map USGS The National Map. Roads, towns and stops © OpenStreetMap contributors. Built September 29, 2026. Printed maps go out of date. Live conditions at milecheckapp.com/passes/vail/

Driving Vail Pass

When it closes

Vail Pass sits well above treeline on both approaches, so it takes the full force of Rocky Mountain storms with little wind protection. Heavy snow, whiteouts, and avalanche control work close I-70 here several times most winters, sometimes for hours at a stretch. It's also one of the most crash-prone stretches on the corridor when a storm hits during peak ski traffic.

Are chains required on Vail Pass?

CDOT sets traction and chain law restrictions on I-70 over the summit, and they change fast in a storm. This is one of the more frequently restricted stretches on the corridor.

How high is Vail Pass?

10,662 feet, lower than the Eisenhower Tunnel 40 miles east, but more exposed to wind and

blowing snow since it's an open summit, not a tunnel.

How far is Vail Pass from Denver?

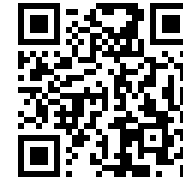
About 100 miles west on I-70. Track your mile marker over the summit with the MileCheck app on CarPlay or Android Auto.

Where are the plows?

The live page shows each one as an arrow pointing the way it is heading. Parked trucks are listed too.

Notes

Live conditions



milecheckapp.com/passes/vail/

Cameras, closures and road reports from CDOT. This sheet was built September 29, 2026. Check the live page before you leave.

Snow and avalanche

Snow depth for this road is measured at the Copper Mountain SNOTEL station, 10,500 ft, about 3 miles from the summit. The avalanche forecast comes from CAIC. Both are on the live page.

In the car

MileCheck shows your mile marker, the nearest camera and the alerts ahead, on CarPlay and Android Auto. The mile marker works without a signal.

About this map

The numbered stops are a selection from OpenStreetMap along the roads this sheet is about. This map does not show every stop. Gates and seasonal closures are not drawn.

Sources for this side

CDOT.